

GUIDELINE



Nationally Consistent Collection of Data on School Students with Disability (NCCD) Operational Guidelines

Approved by: Executive Director, Inclusion & Wellbeing

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Brief Description:

The Nationally Consistent Collection of Data on School Students with Disability (NCCD) Operational Guidelines is intended to increase system wide knowledge of the NCCD and its relationship to Inclusive Practices. The NCCD Operational Guidelines is a supporting document to the Inclusive Education policy for students with disability. It includes guidelines for effective practice, clarifies roles and responsibilities, explains the links to legislation and policy, and provides resources to support capability uplift in schools and the continuous improvement of NCCD data.

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1. Introduction

- 1.1 The NCCD Operational Guidelines (The guidelines) seeks to increase system wide knowledge of the NCCD and its relationship to Inclusive Practices.
- 1.2 The guidelines relate to schools' obligations under the *Disability Discrimination Act 1992 (DDA)*, the *Disability Standards for Education 2005 (DSE)*, the *Australian Education Regulations 2023*, and the NSW Department of Education's *Inclusive Education for students with disability* policy.

2. Audience and application

- 2.1 The guidelines apply to NSW government schools.
- 2.2 Pre-schools and schools with no census enrolments are exempt from the NCCD process. If a school has primary or secondary students, including those in support classes, enrolled through the Enrolment and Registration Number system (ERN), it is expected that they complete the Disability Adjustments tab within ERN for all eligible students and ensure the inclusion of those students in the NCCD count.

3. Responsibilities and delegations

3.1 Principals:

- 3.1.1 establish a school team responsible for managing the NCCD process and establishing and maintaining record collection and storage systems
- 3.1.2 participate in professional learning for school leaders, and identify and support the professional learning needs for staff to build understanding of the school's legislative obligations and the NCCD
- 3.1.3 support school staff in establishing processes for the NCCD, including moderation processes
- 3.1.4 notify the school community of the annual NCCD data collection
- 3.1.5 verify and confirm NCCD data, backed by documented evidence. Finalise data collection and ensure appropriate records of evidence are stored for audit purposes
- 3.1.6 submit NCCD data
- 3.1.7 support school staff in completing a reflection process using data to inform practices across the school and adjust school practices and processes where necessary.

3.2 Learning and support team:

- 3.2.1** participate in professional learning to build understanding of the school's legislative obligations and the NCCD
- 3.2.2** establish processes for the NCCD, inclusive of moderation processes
- 3.2.3** support classroom teachers to identify, assess, respond to and monitor the additional learning needs of students
- 3.2.4** support classroom teachers to comply with the established record collection and storage systems
- 3.2.5** identify evidence of the level of adjustment provided for each student included in the NCCD and of the adjustment/s having been provided for a minimum of 10 weeks
- 3.2.6** identify the category of disability for each student included in the NCCD, informed by evidence that the student has a disability as defined in the DDA
- 3.2.7** conduct a moderation process to ensure accuracy, consistency and reliability of the NCCD data
- 3.2.8** conduct a reflection process on the application of the NCCD model and adjust school practices and processes where necessary.

3.3 Teachers:

- 3.3.1** build understanding of the school's legislative obligations and the NCCD
- 3.3.2** provide reasonable adjustments to students with disability
- 3.3.3** consult with parents, carers, guardians and students on their education and adjustments on an ongoing basis
- 3.3.4** apply the established record collection and storage systems for evidence of assessed student need, implementation of adjustments, consultation and collaboration, and monitoring and review of adjustments
- 3.3.5** make initial judgements on levels of adjustment in collaboration with the school team
- 3.3.6** participate in the identification of evidence to support validation processes
- 3.3.7** participate in moderation and reflection processes.

3.4 Inclusive education

- 3.4.1** oversee the development and implementation of research, policy and practice relevant to inclusive education under the department's commitments to inclusive education and other related initiatives
- 3.4.2** lead and collaborate across the department to develop evidence-based resources, professional learning, and facilitate mentoring and support to strengthen NCCD practices to build the capability of schools and Team Around a School to meet the needs of their students
- 3.4.3** build an evidence base of best practice to improve outcomes for students with disability for teachers and school leaders to access
- 3.4.4** provision of ongoing support and advice to enable schools to plan for and undertake the annual NCCD via the NCCD Team
- 3.4.5** build the capability of Team Around a School to support schools to lead improvements in data quality, including consistency of teacher judgements
- 3.4.6** update and establish technical guides to support data entry and monitoring, including ERN – Disability Adjustments, Online Data Collections Website and Monitoring Report
- 3.4.7** provide access to NCCD data to support policy development and inform guided/strategic support to schools
- 3.4.8** support Team Around a School to follow up with schools in relation to potential data entry errors
- 3.4.9** support ongoing improvement in the consistency and quality of NCCD data.

3.5 Student Wellbeing Support (Team Around a School)

- 3.5.1** work closely with schools to partner in identifying and implementing student-focused initiatives
- 3.5.2** readily available access to specialists and experienced staff to provide timely and accurate support and advice on wellbeing matters
- 3.5.3** partnering with schools to provide additional targeted support to individual students
- 3.5.4** assisting school teams to improve student learning and wellbeing practices
- 3.5.5** strengthening school and staff initiatives across the wellbeing continuum of care

3.5.6 support with individual student plans, support for diverse learners, complex student needs and case support, behaviour support, development of specific Teams Within a School, policy advice, and developing external agency partnerships with schools.

3.5.7 professional learning.

3.6 Centre for Education Statistics and Evaluation

3.6.1 collect, analyse and report on information about NSW government school students with disability

3.6.2 provide technical support to schools to complete the NCCD

3.6.3 submit NCCD data to the Commonwealth Department of Education by the first week of October each year.

4. Description

4.1 The guidelines include guidelines for effective practice, clarifies roles and responsibilities, explains the links to legislation and policy, and provides resources to support capability uplift in schools and the continuous improvement of NCCD data.

5. Key information

5.1 What is the NCCD?

[The Nationally Consistent Collection of Data \(NCCD\)](#) is an annual collection of information about Australian school students with disability. The NCCD enables schools, education authorities and governments to better understand the needs of students with disability and how they can be best supported at school.

5.2 Key dates for schools



5.3 What is the purpose of the NCCD?

- the NCCD collects data annually about students with disability who are receiving adjustments to access education
- it enables schools, education authorities and governments to better understand the needs of students with disability and how they can best be supported at school
- since 2018 the student with disability loading provided by the Australian Government has been based on NCCD data. In 2023 the NSW Low Level Adjustment for Disability (LLAD) aligned with the NCCD.

5.4 Which students must be included in the NCCD?

A student must be counted in the NCCD when all the following requirements are met:

- the student has a disability under the [Disability Discrimination Act 1992](#)
- the school has relevant evidence
- the [Disability Standards for Education 2005](#) have been met, including parent, carer and guardian consultation
- the school has provided information about the NCCD to parents, carers, and guardians
- the student received adjustments for their disability for at least 10 weeks in the 12 months before Census Day (the student must also be currently enrolled on Census Day).

Key points to note:

- The minimum 10-week period does not need to be consecutive. It can be cumulative and split across school terms in the 12 months before the NCCD Census Day.
- If a student is participating in a school-based activity during the school holidays (e.g. camp) and the school is providing adjustments, then this time can be included in the 10 weeks.
- The 10-week period can be across schools. If a student changes schools, the period adjustments were made at the previous school can be included, provided the evidence is made available.

5.5 What is the definition of a student with disability?

The NCCD uses the definition of disability from the Disability Discrimination Act 1992 (DDA).

Disability is defined very broadly in the DDA. It includes:

- loss of bodily function
- damage to bodily function
- disease or illness
- disorders of thought processes, emotions, judgement, or behaviour

Students must be included in the NCCD if they have been provided with an adjustment to address the functional impact of a disability for a minimum of 10 weeks. The functional impact of a student's disability can include the impact on communication, mobility, curriculum access, personal care, and social participation. Other areas that might be considered for some students are motor development, emotional wellbeing, sensory needs, and transitions.

The Disability Standards for Education 2005 (DSE) and DDA apply to all students with disability, and to students who are carers of someone with disability, even if they themselves do not have disability. A proportion of students included in the NCCD will have a formal diagnosis of disability supported by medical or allied health professionals' diagnostic reports. The definition covers students who do not have a formal diagnosis for their disability, but a disability can be imputed based on their condition or behaviour.

Further information can be found on the NCCD portal: [When is a student eligible to be included?](#)

5.6 Imputing disability for the NCCD

An 'imputed' disability refers to the attribution of a disability by one individual to another based on their personal belief or perception. In cases where a student's disability has not been formally diagnosed, a school team may 'impute' disability for the purposes of the NCCD. A school team will impute disability when they believe, based on **reasonable grounds**, and supported by **documented evidence**, that an undiagnosed disability is having a functional impact on the student's capacity to access and participate in education on the same basis as their peers.

Key points to note:

- At a minimum the student's parent, carer or guardian must have been consulted about the student's identified support needs and has been involved in identifying reasonable adjustments to address those needs. If attempts to consult are unsuccessful, there must be evidence of attempted consultation.
- Imputing disability is not equivalent to diagnosing disability. School teams may impute disability based on the DDA definitions and, for the purposes of the NCCD, describe the disability in terms of the four broad categories: physical, cognitive, sensory, or social/emotional.
- While the school team may identify characteristics of disability, a diagnosis can only be made by qualified medical or allied health professionals. School teams should take care to avoid labelling characteristics with a specific diagnosis.

Further information can be found on the NCCD portal: [Imputing disability for the NCCD](#)

6. Underpinning legislation and policy

These guidelines should be read in conjunction with the [Disability Discrimination Act 1992 \(DDA\)](#), the [Disability Standards for Education 2005 \(DSE\)](#) and the NSW Department of Education's [Inclusive Education Statement for students with disability](#) and [Inclusive Education Policy for](#)

[students with disability](#). The [Australian Education Regulations 2023](#) requires all schools report the data collected for the NCCD to the Australian Government on an annual basis.

6.1 Disability Discrimination Act 1992 (DDA)

The Disability Discrimination Act 1992 (Cth) is National law which prohibits discrimination against people with disabilities, and extends to the disability of an associate, such as a friend, partner, carer or family member of the person.

Under the DDA it is illegal to treat a person with disability less favourably than a person without disability.

The DDA has a very broad definition of disability and includes disability that may be imputed.

6.2 Disability Standards for Education 2005 (DSE)

The DSE is subordinate legislation under the DDA. The DSE clarifies schools' obligations and the rights of students with disability under the DDA.

[Schools' obligations:](#)

- provide reasonable adjustments to allow students with disability to access and participate in education **on the same basis*** as their peers
- eliminate harassment and victimisation
- consult students, parents, carers and guardians about students' disabilities and needs.

[*'On the same basis' means students with disability:](#)

- are entitled to have the same opportunities and choices in their education that are made available to students without disability
- have a right to access rigorous, relevant, and engaging learning opportunities set in age-equivalent contexts
- do not need to have the same experience as their peers but are entitled to equitable opportunities and choices to access and participate in learning and may access education in a different way to their peers and their learning may vary according to their individual needs, strengths, goals, and interests.

All state and territory education providers, including government and non-government schools, must comply with the DSE.

6.3 NSW Inclusive Education Statement for students with disability

The NSW Department of Education is committed to building a more inclusive education system. An education system where every student is known, valued and cared for and all students are learning

to their fullest capability. This Statement marks the next stage of our work to further embed inclusive practice in NSW public schools, including NSW Government preschools. It is part of the commitment to the pursuit of excellence and the provision of high-quality educational opportunities for every child, across all of NSW public schools. This Statement focuses on the principles of inclusive practice for students with disability, whilst recognising that improving inclusive practice benefits all students. Our continuing journey towards embedding inclusive practice across the education system will be guided by the following principles:

1. Student agency and self-determination
2. Parent and carer inclusion
3. Social and cultural inclusion
4. Curriculum inclusion
5. Workforce capability for inclusion
6. System inclusion

6.4 NSW Inclusive Education for students with disability policy

The Inclusive Education policy provides guidance to support the inclusion of students with disability and additional needs in NSW public schools under the DDA and DSE. The policy restates and clarifies the obligations of all school staff under the DSE to provide reasonable adjustments in consultation with students, parents, carers and guardians.

6.5 Australian Education Regulations 2023

The Australian Education Regulations 2023 requires all schools report the data collected for the NCCD to the Australian Government on an annual basis. The NCCD is a count of students in schools who meet the DDA's definition of disability and who require adjustments to access and participate in education on the same basis as students without disability. The NCCD data collection records evidence of DSE compliance throughout the school year.

7. Guidance for effective practice

7.1 The NCCD model

The NCCD model outlines a clear process for schools in to identify the number of students with disability receiving adjustments to access education.

The model involves four steps:

1. [Is the student receiving an adjustment?](#) Identify which students are receiving adjustments to access education due to a disability, in line with the definitions and obligations under the DDA and the DSE.
2. [What is the level of adjustment?](#) Decide what level of adjustment is being provided to the student and gather evidence to support the decision.
3. [What is the category of disability?](#) Decide which broad category of disability the student fits best and gather evidence to support the decision.
4. [Record, verify and submit the data.](#)

View the [NCCD model diagram](#).

7.2 Levels of adjustment

The following information is from the NCCD [Selecting the level of adjustment](#) document. Once it has been determined that the student meets the criteria to be included in the NCCD, the school team should determine the level of adjustment being provided. The *Selecting the level of adjustment* document provides level descriptors, typical adjustments, and student characteristics. This document should be used to determine accurate levels of adjustment for reporting in the NCCD.

Further resources include:

- [Guide to choosing the level of adjustment](#) (These checklists are designed to assist schools in differentiating between the four levels of adjustment).
- [Levels of adjustment viewer](#) (This tool can be used to compare two level of adjustment descriptors).

There are four levels of adjustment:

1. [Support provided within quality differentiated teaching practice \(QDTP\)](#)
 - a. Students with disability are supported through active monitoring and adjustments that are not greater than those used to meet the needs of diverse learners.
 - b. These adjustments are provided through usual school processes, without drawing on additional resources, and by meeting proficient-level Teaching Standards (AITSL).
2. [Supplementary adjustments](#)
 - a. Students with disability are provided with adjustments that are supplementary to the strategies and resources already available for all students within the school.

3. Substantial adjustments

- a. Students with disability who have more substantial support needs are provided with essential adjustments and considerable adult assistance.

4. Extensive adjustments

- a. Students with disability and very high support needs are provided with extensive targeted measures and sustained levels of intensive support. These adjustments are highly individualised, comprehensive and ongoing.

7.3 Categories of disability

The following information is from the NCCD [categories of disability](#) document. The category definitions are from the DDA.

Once the school team has determined the level of adjustment being provided to the student, they should review the available evidence to determine the student's disability category. A student's disability category in the NCCD relies on the professional judgement of the teacher, based on the evidence available. The disability category selected will be the area of disability that is the main driver of the adjustments being provided for the student to support their learning. If a student has multiple disabilities or doesn't neatly fit into a single category, school teams should select the disability category that demands the greatest extent of reasonable adjustment/s.

There are four categories of disability:

1. Physical

- a. Total or partial loss of a part of the body
- b. The malfunction, malformation or disfigurement of a part of the person's body
- c. The presence in the body of organisms causing disease or illness
- d. The presence in the body of organisms capable of causing disease or illness

2. Cognitive

- a. Total or partial loss of the person's bodily or mental functions
- b. A disorder or malfunction that results in the person learning differently from a person without the disorder or malfunction

3. Sensory

- a. Total or partial loss of the person's bodily or mental functions
- b. The malfunction, malformation or disfigurement of a part of the person's body

4. Social/Emotional

- a. A disorder, illness or disease that affects the person's thought processes, perception of reality, emotions or judgement, or that results in disturbed behaviour

7.4 Personalised learning and support

Personalised learning and support is underpinned by evidence of four key elements or areas of activity:

1. Assessed individual student needs
2. Consultation and collaboration
3. Provision of adjustments
4. Monitoring the impact of adjustments

How does the NCCD relate to personalised learning and support?

The NCCD captures the work of schools in providing adjustments for students with disability, in line with the DDA, DSE and the department's Inclusive Education policy for students with disability.

Having practical systems to collect evidence ensures that personalised learning and support processes are well-documented, consistent, and readily accessible for the NCCD data collection (*examples of evidence can be found on pages 16 and 17*).

Inclusive practices supporting the four elements of personalised learning and support should be ongoing and embedded, throughout the school year, with feedback informing continuous improvements to program delivery.

This facilitates the completion of the NCCD and assists schools to incorporate the evidence identification process into their teaching and learning schedules from early in the year.

[Visit the department webpage on personalised learning and support for more information.](#)

Further resources

- The [NESA collaborative curriculum planning](#) process can also help to determine the most appropriate curriculum options and adjustments for a student with disability. Collaborative curriculum planning takes place within the broader context of personalised planning and includes interventions and other supports to address identified student learning and support needs.
- The [Inclusive Practice hub](#) provides evidence-based practice resources for schools to support students with disability and additional needs.
- Learn more about [evidence-based practices](#) and access additional resources to support the learning and wellbeing outcomes for students with disability.

7.5 Evidence

Evidence across four key areas of personalised learning and support must be retained for seven years to support the decision to include a student in the NCCD, however not all students will require the same amount of evidence. Below are some examples of evidence from the departments Personalised Learning and Support page:

Assessed individual student need

- Results from assessments that document ongoing support needs
- Parental observations and reports in conjunction with evidence of assessed individual need
- School based data such as personalised learning plans, behaviour support plans or risk assessments that identify the functional needs of a student
- Specialist diagnosis or reports from a medical practitioner or specialists
- Teacher professional learning to meet a student's individual needs.

Provision of adjustments

- Adjustments to teaching and learning for individual students.
- Records of educational and social-emotional supports provided for the student.
- Personalised plans that address specific learning and support needs of the student and records of their implementation, such as personalised learning and support plans, communication, behaviour, health care and transition
- Adjustments to learning materials
- Environmental adjustments beyond those already in place in the school
- Records of professional learning for teachers and school staff that support them in meeting identified student needs.

Consultation and collaboration

- Records of meetings held at school to plan for and review adjustments involving teachers, students, their parents and carers, other specialist staff and professionals, such as learning and support team.
- Records of discussions and decisions about the provision of adjustments for the student.
- Documented student plans signed by the student and their parents and carers.
- Records of parent-teacher interviews and parent-teacher communication books.
- Records of unsuccessful attempts at parent, carer, and guardian consultation e.g., a note in the student record.

Monitoring the impact of adjustments

- Student progress data, including both formative and summative assessment.
- Collection and review of specific data relevant to planned personalised adjustments or interventions, such as behaviour, health care, communication, attendance, and learning achievement.
- Health care plans provided by medical specialists that have been reviewed regularly.
- Records of meetings to review adjustments, with individual students, parents and carers, teachers, support staff and specialist staff.
- Evidence of ongoing interventions provided for the student that have been reviewed and monitored to assess impact and effectiveness.

NCCD evidence templates

The [NCCD evidence templates](#) help schools collect evidence in a way that is consistent with the NCCD guidelines, the DDA the DSE. These templates are designed to help schools capture and record evidence of teaching practices and decision-making processes that support students with disability, including the provision of adjustments, determining the category of disability, identifying evidence and data collection.

It is not compulsory for schools to use these templates. Schools can choose to use them as part of their existing processes, as a suite or as individual templates. The NCCD evidence templates have been developed with input from schools and have been created to assist teaching and support staff to plan and deliver adjustments for students with disability and comply with the NCCD guidelines.

7.6 Personalised learning plans

Personalised learning pathways

All Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander students require a personalised learning pathway. If they also require adjustments to their learning due to a disability or imputed disability, a personalised learning and support plan (PLSP) should be considered. A PLSP should not be considered a substitute for the personalised learning pathway.

For more information view the [Personalised Learning Pathways Guidelines](#).

Out of home care plans

The principal is responsible for ensuring the development of personalised learning and support planning for a student in statutory out of home care who is enrolling in the school, or when it is known an existing student is entering care. The principal is responsible for ensuring its development within 30 school days of notification that the child or young person has entered, or is

in, out of home care and that it is revised at least annually. The personalised learning and support planning may include disability, transition, behaviour or health care planning.

For more information visit [Out of Home Care](#).

7.7 Consultation with parents, carers and guardians for the NCCD

Do parents, carers and guardians need to be notified of the NCCD?

The principal must notify all students and parents, guardians, carers or associates to ensure the whole school community is aware of:

- the data collection
- purpose of the NCCD
- the legislative basis
- to whom NCCD data will be disclosed
- assurance activities that may be conducted by the department.

Information, such as letters and newsletter articles, can be sent to the whole school community on an annual basis, regardless of whether a student is being counted in the NCCD. There are generic templates available below with information about the NCCD that can be amended to suit your context.

[Sample letter for parents, guardians, carers and associates](#)

[Australian Government NCCD information notice](#)

Informing a parent carer or guardian that a student is being included in the NCCD

Schools should inform parents, guardians, carers or associates that a student has been included in the NCCD.

In some circumstances, a school may be unable to appropriately engage with parents, guardians, carers or associates on a student's inclusion in the NCCD. For example, they may:

- be uncomfortable with the label 'disability' and the provision of the necessary adjustments
- not believe their child has a disability
- request that the school not include the student in the NCCD
- not respond to the school's efforts at communication.

In such circumstances, the reason(s) for not engaging further should be documented.

When attempts made by a school to inform parents, guardians, carers or associates that their student is included in the NCCD have been unsuccessful, these attempts should be documented. This documentation need not be extensive, for example a note in the student record would suffice.

In all cases, the school must still include students in the NCCD and provide appropriate adjustment(s), regardless of parent, guardian or carer engagement or consent. A Fact Sheet for parents, guardians, carers, and associates is available on the NCCD portal.

Engaging with Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander communities

Establishing strong connections between Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander students, families, communities, and the school is crucial for the academic success, achievements, and overall involvement of the students.

To foster engagement and positive relationships with families and communities, it is essential for the school to gain trust and show respect by creating an inclusive and welcoming environment that ensures cultural safety.

These strong connections play a vital role in ensuring that Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander students, families, and communities are actively involved in the personalised learning journey and are well-informed about the annual data collection conducted by the NCCD.

If you require support, please reach out to your [Aboriginal Community Liaison Officer](#).

7.8 Moderation

What is moderation?

Moderation involves conversation and collaboration among school staff, which results in a consistent approach to determining the levels of adjustment and category of disability. Moderation is one of the most important practices that teachers use to align professional judgements.

Through moderation, teachers and leaders discuss how they have interpreted and used the NCCD guidelines and processes. Moderation can be formal or informal and can involve inter-school collaborations, which can be particularly useful for staff working in smaller schools.

Schools should engage in moderation before the official data entry period. By engaging in the moderation process before the data entry date, schools are better able to address any significant discrepancies in judgements that could affect the consistency and reliability of data.

What is the importance of moderation processes for the NCCD?

The NCCD process requires interpretation of various guidelines and standards and is subject to individual and school-level factors that can impact the accuracy and consistency of teacher judgments.

A research report on [NCCD teacher judgement](#) has found that moderation is a vital tool for improving the validity, reliability and consistency of teacher judgments and improving the quality of data collection and reporting for students with disability. Teachers can utilise moderation to build

knowledge, develop skills, and implement systems for data and evidence collection that minimise variation in NCCD data.

Moderation can also contribute to the professional growth and development of teachers, and foster a culture of collaboration, accountability, and continuous improvement in schools.

Strong leadership, a whole school approach, reliance on teacher judgment, and formal and informal moderation processes are all essential elements for accurate and consistent NCCD data collection in school.

Key activities in the NCCD moderation process

1. [Select moderators](#)
2. [Select students for moderation](#)
3. [Share student evidence with moderation team](#)
4. [Student evidence informs initial judgements](#)
5. [Compare judgements](#)
6. [Reach consensus](#)

For a detailed explanation of the moderation process you can view the [NCCD moderation resource for schools](#) or access moderation resources in the NCCD toolkit.

7.9 Entering, reviewing, and submitting the data

Enrolment and Registration Number system (ERN) disability adjustments

The Disability Adjustments section of ERN provides access to schools to identify students for inclusion in the NCCD. Once students have been identified, the school is able to access a series of questions for each student which determine whether the student will be included in the NCCD:

- Does the student have a disability under the Disability Discrimination Act (DDA)?
- Identify disability categories
- Identify primary disability category
- Identify the level of adjustment/support provided
- Does the school have relevant evidence?
- Have the Disability Standards for Education been met, including parent/carers consultation?
- Has the school provided information about the NCCD to parents/carers?
- Has the student been provided with long term adjustment(s)/ support due to disability in the past 12 months? (Minimum 10 weeks for inclusion in NCCD)

This list of identified students forms the basis of the school's NCCD data submission. Data from the list is "harvested" daily (Monday – Friday) during the NCCD Pre-Census Data Review Stage and shown on the Online Data Collection for Schools website for review.

The final data harvest is taken at 5pm on Census Date (the last day of the Pre-Census Data Review Stage) and is shown on the Online Data Collection for Schools website for final review and sign off by the principal. More information on using the Disability Adjustments section of ERN can be found in the [ERN Disability Adjustments User Guide](#).

Online Data Collection for Schools website

The pre-census data review stage and the census stage of the NCCD can each be accessed via the Data Collection for Schools website.



During the pre-census data review stage, Principals can access the data collections website to review the data harvested from ERN. Changes made in ERN during the pre-census review stage will update on the Data Collection for Schools website the next day.

During the census stage of the NCCD, Principals review all entries and when they are satisfied that the data in the Students with Disability (NCCD) return is correct, they need to sign off on the census return. Signing and submitting the Students with Disability (NCCD) return confirms that the data is correct, and all steps have been completed. In some cases, schools may be contacted by the NCCD Team (Inclusive Education) after signing off to obtain context around their submitted data.

For guidance accessing the ERN disability adjustments tab or Online Data Collection for Schools website please visit the [NCCD toolkit](#).

8. More information

8.1 I need further NCCD resources

- [NCCD toolkit](#)
- [Australian Government NCCD portal](#)

8.2 I have a question about the NCCD

- Contact the department NCCD team at nccd@det.nsw.edu.au
- Department [NCCD FAQs](#)
- [Contact your Assistant Principal Learning and Support \(APLAS\)](#)

9. Document history

9.1 Document information

Guideline title	NCCD Operational Guidelines
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Next scheduled review date	
Audience	Internal/External
Location in taxonomy	Administration
Subject keywords	Guidelines, requirements

9.2 Document accountability

Role	Name
Guideline Owner	Executive Director, Inclusive Education
Guideline Advisor	Director, Inclusive Education
Guideline Facilitator	NCCD data manager
Guideline Contact	NCCD data manager

9.3 Document version history

Version	Date	Author	Change description
1.0	27 April 2023	Inclusive Education	Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.
1.1	2 May 2023	Inclusive Education	Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.
1.2	18 May 2023	Inclusive Education	Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.
1.3	11 September 2023	Inclusive Education	Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.

1.4	9 October 2023	Inclusive Education	Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.
1.5	16 October 2023	Inclusive Education	Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.
1.6	25 October 2023	Inclusive Education	Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.
1.7	31 October 2023	Inclusive Education	Document shifted into department guidelines template. Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.
1.8	February 2024	Inclusive Education	Stakeholder feedback was reviewed, addressed, and where appropriate embedded in the resources. If feedback was considered out of scope it was recorded and acknowledged.

9.4 Consultation

Date (2023)	Stakeholder
9 March	Tasmania Department of Education
16 March	Northern Territory Department of Education
5 April	DoE Policy Team
2 May, 11 Sept	Disability Funding Reform (DFR) team , Inclusive Education, Inclusion & Wellbeing
25 May	Disability Funding Reform (DFR) and Delivery Support planning day
13 April, 6 July, 11 Sept	NCCD team , Specialist Support Services, Inclusive Education, Inclusion & Wellbeing
3 May, 22 June, 4 Oct	NCCD Working Party Representatives from: - Child Wellbeing and Mental Health Services, Student Support and Specialist Programs - Curriculum Early Years and Primary Learners, Curriculum & Reform - Secondary Learners, Curriculum & Reform - Aboriginal Outcomes and Partnerships - School Planning Budgeting and Reporting team - Assisted School Travel Program - Delivery Support, Student Wellbeing Support
23 and 29 May	Voice of Schools
21 July 2023	Director, Inclusive Education
3 May, 12 Sept, 4 Oct	Delivery Support , Student Wellbeing Services
July to Sept	NCCD Targeted School Strategy (18 schools)
9 August	Queensland Department of Education
17 August	PPA SSP Reference Group
18 August	PPA Disability Programs Reference Group
27 August	SPC Disability Reference Group

Guideline: *NCCD Operational Guidelines*

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8 Sept, 3 Oct	Assistant principal learning and support (APLaS) working group
30 Oct	NCCD team , Specialist Support Services, Inclusive Education, Inclusion & Wellbeing
11 December	NSW Teachers Federation

9.5 Document linkages

Legislation and regulation

Key relevant legislation and regulation that determines influences or defines this guideline:

Year of enactment	Title of legislation
1992	<i>Disability Discrimination Act</i>
2005	<i>Disability Standards for Education</i>
2023	<i>Australian Education Regulation</i>

Policies and procedures

Reference policies and procedures that are associated with this guideline:

Type	PD number	Title
Policy		Inclusive Education for students with disability

10. Terms and definitions

Term	Definition
Adjustment	<i>Actions taken to help students with additional learning and support needs (including disability) participate in education on the same basis as students without disability.</i>
Assessment	<i>A test or any task or activity designed to find out what a student has learnt or is able to do.</i>
Associates	<i>For most students, 'associates' means their parents, guardians or carers but can include other nominated persons or advocates.</i> <i>'Associate' includes:</i> <i>a relative of the person</i> <i>a carer of the person</i> <i>a spouse of the person</i> <i>another person who is living with the person on a genuine domestic basis</i> <i>another person who is in a business, sporting or recreational relationship with the person.</i>
Data harvest/Harvested	<i>Data harvest in the context of the NCCD is referring to obtaining the Online data collections NCCD data from the ERN disability adjustments dataset.</i>
DDA	<i>Disability Discrimination Act 1992 (DDA). The DDA makes it against the law to treat people unfairly because of a disability.</i>
Disability	<i>Disability is defined in section 4 of the Disability Discrimination Act 1992.</i>
Discrimination	<i>When someone is treated less favourably than another person in similar circumstances because they have, or their associate has, an attribute (such as age or disability) covered by the Disability Discrimination Act 1992 or other laws. Discrimination can be direct or indirect.</i>
DSE	<i>Disability Standards for Education 2005. A framework to clarify the obligations of education and training providers and ensure that students with disability are able to access and participate in education on the same basis as other students.</i>
Education authorities	<i>A body or person administering an educational institution.</i>
Enrolment and Registration Number system (ERN)	<i>The Enrolment and Registration Number system (ERN) is a web-based, central database that is used to manage the student enrolment processes.</i>
Evidence-based practice	<i>In education, an evidence-based practice (EBP) is an educational intervention that has been evaluated in research and found to be effective for supporting students to learn and succeed at school. An intervention may refer to an instructional practice, program, or curriculum that addresses any academic or behavioural outcome.</i>
Imputed disability	<i>An 'imputed' disability is something that someone believes another person has. To impute a disability, the school team must have reasonable grounds to make such a judgement.</i>
Inclusive education	<i>Inclusive education means that all students, regardless of disability, ethnicity, socioeconomic status, nationality, language, gender, sexual orientation or faith, can access and fully participate in learning, alongside their similar-aged peers, supported by reasonable adjustments and teaching strategies tailored to meet their individual needs. Inclusion is embedded in all aspects of school life and is supported by culture, policies and everyday practices.</i>

Term	Definition
Low Level Adjustment for Disability (LLAD)	<i>Equity loading which is based on the number of students in regular classes with low level disability and learning support needs. The LLAD funds Learning and Support teacher positions in schools and provides an amount of flexible funding.</i>
Moderation	<i>As it relates to the NCCD, moderation allows individuals within a school to collaborate, validate and learn from one another to regulate the assessment and data collection process. It is a key treatment in reducing variability in teacher professional judgement.</i>
School obligations	<i>In the context of the NCCD, schools' obligations refer to schools being legally bound to comply with the relevant legislation.</i>
On the same basis	<i>'On the same basis' means that a student with disability must have opportunities and choices comparable with those offered to students without disability in relation to:</i> - <i>admission or enrolment in an institution</i> - <i>participation in courses or programs</i> - <i>use of facilities and services.</i>
Operational guidelines	<i>A document that outlines the rules, responsibilities, processes, and policies necessary for the proper organisation and administration of an objective.</i>
Personalised learning pathways	<i>Document is used by schools to ensure Aboriginal and/ or Torres Strait Islander students and their families are actively engaged in meaningful planning and decision-making in education. PLP conversations are of great importance as they identify and strengthen shared understandings of aspirational goals, expectations, and responsibilities.</i>
Personalised learning and support	<i>Personalised learning and support aims to fulfil the diverse capabilities of each student. It requires attention to the unique needs of students of all abilities, acknowledging the different learning needs of each student. This is particularly relevant for students with disability and additional learning needs. Personalised learning and support may involve one or a combination of approaches in relation to curriculum, instruction and the environment.</i>
Reasonable adjustment	<i>An adjustment is reasonable if it balances the interests of all parties affected.</i> <i>Learn more about reasonable adjustments in Section 3.4 of the Disability Standards for Education 2005.</i>
School census	<i>The national school census is required under the Australian Education Act 2013. Data from this census is used to calculate school funding, to inform education policy and programs and for statistical reporting, including the National Schools Statistics Collection.</i>
School team	<i>The principal may identify and nominate a school team to drive the NCCD process.</i>
Student with disability	<i>A student who meets the disability definition criteria in the Disability Discrimination Act 1992.</i>
Validation	<i>In the context of the NCCD, validation is when a principal verifies and confirms the accuracy of the school's NCCD data before it is submitted.</i>